

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

EVALUATOR:

DATE:

PRODUCT:

TASK:

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

lack immediate, "live" confirmation. Without success messages or moving icons, the user isn't quite sure if their submission worked or if the truck's location is actually updating in real-time.

Recommendations

replacing static pins with a gliding truck icon and a "Last updated" timestamp would transform the experience from a static image into a reliable, real-time tool. These small cues reassure the user that the system is active and responsive to their needs.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

The live tracking map uses generic, abstract pins and a thin line that looks more like a data graph than a real-world navigation path. For a non-technical user, these symbols don't immediately "speak the language" of a neighborhood street or a physical truck moving through their specific zone.

Recommendations

I suggest replacing the abstract pins with a recognizable truck icon and using a standard navigation-style path (like Google Maps) to mimic real-world conventions. Making the map markers look like actual landmarks or houses would help the interface feel more natural and intuitive to a resident waiting at the curb.

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

The login and account selection flow lacks a prominent "emergency exit" or a simple way to cancel the process once a user has started. If a user accidentally taps the wrong social login or chooses the incorrect Google account, they are forced to proceed through several screens before they can revert or change their mind, which can lead to frustration and a feeling of being "trapped" in the sequence.

Recommendations

Introduce a clear "Cancel" or "Back" button on every step of the onboarding and login screens to allow users to instantly retreat from an unwanted action. Providing an easily discoverable exit link ensures that users can correct mistakes immediately without having to navigate through an extended, multi-step process.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

The design exhibits visual inconsistencies in iconography, where the solid-fill style in the navigation bar conflicts with different line weights used on other screens. This mix of styles can confuse users, making them question if different-looking icons still represent the same basic functions.

Recommendations

Standardize all visual treatments by adopting a single icon set that matches the high-quality, solid-fill style of the navigation bar. Maintaining this uniformity across all pages ensures a predictable experience and follows established industry standards for professional UI design.

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5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

The location setup screen uses open dropdown menus or text fields for "Municipality" and "Barangay" that could allow for invalid entries if not properly constrained. Without proactive validation or clear formatting guides, a user might easily select the wrong area or enter a typo, leading to incorrect tracking data later in the process.

Recommendations

Implement smart constraints, such as auto-suggesting valid locations or using a map-pin selection tool, to eliminate error-prone conditions. By guiding the user toward correct choices during the setup phase, you prevent significant downstream slips before they ever occur.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

The location setup and settings screens require the user to remember their specific "Street/Zone" or "Barangay" details without providing a visual map or a list of recent choices. This increases cognitive load because the user has to recall precise address details from memory rather than simply recognizing their neighborhood on the interface.

Recommendations

Provide visual cues, such as a small map preview during location setup or a "Recent Locations" list, to let users recognize their area instead of typing it out. Making these options visible ensures that critical information is retrievable when needed, minimizing the need for users to memorize specific data points.

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Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

The design lacks "accelerators" or shortcuts for frequent actions, such as a one-tap button to view the current live tracking status or the next collection date directly from the landing page. Experienced users who check the app daily are forced to navigate through the same standard process as a first-time user, which slows down efficiency for those who only need a quick update.

Recommendations

Add a customizable "Quick View" widget or support for long-press shortcuts on the app icon to let expert users jump straight to the live map or their schedule. Allowing users to tailor their frequent actions or providing gesture-based shortcuts ensures the interface stays simple for novices while becoming highly efficient for power users.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

The "More" and "Settings" screens contain dense blocks of text and redundant descriptions that compete with the primary action buttons. This clutter makes the interface feel crowded, forcing the user to sift through secondary information—like long legal disclaimers or excessive help text—to find the actual toggle or menu item they need.

Recommendations

Apply a "less is more" approach by stripping away non-essential descriptions and moving secondary text, such as company info or detailed FAQs, to a nested "About" section. By focusing solely on functional essentials and increasing white space, you improve the visibility of core actions and ensure the minimalist aesthetic remains clean and focused.

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Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

The current design lacks visual indicators for input errors, particularly on the location setup and feedback screens. If a user leaves a required field blank or enters incompatible data, the system does not use traditional error visuals—like bold red text or high-contrast icons—to highlight exactly where the problem occurred, leaving the user to guess how to fix the issue.

Recommendations

Implement clear, constructive error messages in plain language that appear immediately next to the problematic field. Use industry-standard visual cues, such as red outlines or warning icons, to precisely indicate the problem and suggest a direct solution (e.g., "Please select a Barangay to see your schedule"). This ensures users can recognize the error instantly and recover without frustration.

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

The current design lacks a dedicated, searchable help section or in-context assistance for complex features like the live tracking map or location setup. If a user is confused about what the different map markers represent or how the "Zone" scheduling works, they are forced to figure it out through trial and error because there are no tooltips or "help" icons available at the moment they require them.

Recommendations

I suggest adding a small "Information" or "Help" icon to complex screens that provides a brief, in-context overlay or tooltip explaining the specific features. Additionally, incorporating a simple, searchable FAQ or "How-to" guide within the "More" menu would ensure that users can find detailed documentation whenever they need assistance completing a task.